Epilogue

Three Invaders from Tramontana and Jihad

Babur has mentioned in the *Baburnama* about two invaders from Tramontana, from the time of Prophet Muhammad's demise, who have ruled and conquered Hindustan as below:

a) Mahmud of Ghaznī
b) Muhammad of Ghor

Babur says that the first one's descendants sat long on the seat of government in Hindustan and the second one's slaves and dependents royally shepherded the seat. He considered himself to be the third one.

Babur saw it as his legal right to sit on the throne of Hindustan, drawing inspiration from the Timur's conquest of north-western India. Nevertheless, his actions in days to come (detailed discussion in volume 2) do tell us that jihad and victory of Islam was indeed his main motive once he entered Hindustan. Below is a discussion as the prelude of the Battle of Khanwa in Babur's own words:[*]

> (March 17th, 1527) On Saturday the 13th day of the second Jumāda of the date 933, a day blessed by the words, God hath blessed your Saturday, the army of Islām was encamped near the village of Kānwa, a dependency of Bīāna, hard by a hill which was four miles from the enemies of the Faith. When those accursed infidel foes of Muḥammad's religion heard the reverberation of the armies of Islām, they arrayed their ill-starred forces and moved forward with one heart, relying on their mountain-like, demon-shaped elephants, as had relied the Lords of the Elephant[1] who went to overthrow the sanctuary (ka'ba) of Islām.
>
> Having these elephants, the wretched Hindus
> Became proud, like the Lords of the Elephant;
> Yet were they odious and vile as is the evening of death,
> Blacker than night, outnumbering the stars,